

CITY ORDINANCE NO. 2026-142

**AN ORDINANCE ESTABLISHING A COMMUNITY-BASED
NEIGHBORHOOD WATCH AND DIGITAL INCIDENT REPORTING
PROGRAM IN ALL BARANGAYS OF THE CITY OF MANILA, AND
APPROPRIATING FUNDS THEREFOR**

EXPLANATORY NOTE

This ordinance seeks to strengthen community-based crime prevention efforts across Manila City by formally establishing barangay-level Neighborhood Watch Groups and a centralized digital incident reporting platform, in coordination with the Manila City Public Safety Office and the Philippine National Police.

WHEREAS, public safety data collected through incident reports, community surveys, neighborhood inspections, and interviews with local safety personnel have identified insufficient street lighting, limited surveillance coverage, delayed incident reporting, and low community participation as persistent challenges to public safety in the City of Manila;

WHEREAS, Section 16 of the Local Government Code of 1991 (Republic Act No. 7160) mandates local government units to promote the general welfare, including the maintenance of peace and order, and the preservation of the comfort and convenience of their inhabitants;

WHEREAS, community participation and timely incident reporting are essential components of effective crime prevention and emergency response;

WHEREAS, the establishment of a formal Neighborhood Watch structure and a digital reporting platform will improve coordination between residents and local safety personnel, and enable faster response times to public safety concerns;

WHEREAS, it is the policy of the City Government of Manila to adopt evidence-based, community-driven approaches to crime prevention and public safety.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT ORDAINED by the Sangguniang Panlungsod of the City of Manila, in session assembled, THAT:

SECTION 1. Title.

This Ordinance shall be known as the “Manila Community-Based Neighborhood Watch and Digital Incident Reporting Ordinance of 2026.”

SECTION 2. Declaration of Policy.

It is hereby declared the policy of the City of Manila to promote community participation in crime prevention, strengthen coordination between residents and local safety personnel, and modernize incident reporting through accessible digital tools.

SECTION 3. Establishment of Barangay Neighborhood Watch Groups.

Every barangay in the City of Manila shall organize a Neighborhood Watch Group composed of volunteer residents, to be coordinated by the Barangay Captain in partnership with the Manila City Public Safety Office and the Philippine National Police.

SECTION 4. Digital Incident Reporting Platform.

The Manila City Public Safety Office, in coordination with the City Information and Communications Technology Office, shall establish and maintain a digital platform through which residents may report safety incidents, request assistance, and receive public safety advisories in real time.

SECTION 5. Street Lighting and Surveillance Improvement.

The City Engineering Office shall prioritize the installation and repair of street lighting in areas identified as high-risk in the annual Community Safety Assessment, and shall coordinate with the Public Safety Office to expand CCTV surveillance coverage in such areas.

SECTION 6. Training and Capacity Building.

The Public Safety Office shall conduct regular orientation and training sessions for Neighborhood Watch volunteers on basic incident reporting procedures, emergency response protocols, and proper use of the digital reporting platform.

SECTION 7. Appropriation.

The amount necessary for the implementation of this Ordinance shall be included in the annual budget of the Manila City Public Safety Office, subject to the usual budgeting and auditing rules and regulations.

SECTION 8. Implementing Rules and Regulations.

The Manila City Public Safety Office shall, within sixty (60) days from the effectivity of this Ordinance, promulgate the necessary rules and regulations for its effective implementation.

SECTION 9. Separability Clause.

If any provision of this Ordinance is declared invalid or unconstitutional, the remaining provisions not affected shall remain in full force and effect.

SECTION 10. Effectivity.

This Ordinance shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its publication in a newspaper of general circulation in the City of Manila or posting in conspicuous public places, in accordance with law.

ENACTED by the Sangguniang Panlungsod of the City of Manila.

City Councilor, Sponsor

City Vice Mayor / Presiding Officer